

# **Movie Recommendation System: Performance Analysis and Architecture Report**

## **Executive Summary**

The report is a comprehensive analysis of a hybrid movie recommendation system utilizing both Binary Search Trees (BST) and Graph data structures for efficient movie search and smart movie recommendations. The system addresses the common problem of users spending a lot of time browsing for movies to watch by providing automated recommendations based on preference and similarity analysis.

## **Problem Statement**

When there are long holidays, users find themselves wasting time selecting movies to watch, spending 2-3 hours reading ratings and reviews. This inefficiency necessitates an automated movie suggestion system that is capable of:

- Searching movies quickly by title or genre
- Providing personalized suggestions based on similarity scores
- Saving time spent on human movie choice

## **System Architecture Overview**

### **Core Components**

The system utilizes a number of data structures and algorithms:

1. Movie Class: Encapsulated data model storing movie metadata
2. Binary Search Tree (BST): Quick title-based searching
3. Trie Structure: Prefix-based searching by title and genre
4. Graph Structure: Graph-based recommendations with similarity
5. MovieDatabase: Interface for searching and data storage
6. MovieRecommendationSystem: Controller system integrated

## **Dataset Specifications**

1. Source: imdb\_top\_1000\_cleaned.csv (top 1000 films on IMDb)

2. Key Fields: Series\_Title, genre\_1-3, Director, Star1-4, IMDB\_Rating, Released\_Year, Runtime
3. Data Processing: Normalization of titles, genre extraction, actor/director indexing

## **Data Structure Analysis**

### **Binary Search Tree (BST) Implementation**

#### **Structure and Design**

Python class CatalogueBST:

```
def __init__(self, movie, depth=1):  
    self.movie = movie  
    self.title = movie.title.lower()  
    self.depth = depth  
    self.left = None  
    self.right = None
```

Efficient Searching: Logarithmic search time for balanced trees

Ordered Traversal: In-order traversal gives alphabetically ordered results

#### **Graph Implementation**

##### **Structure and Design**

class MovieGraph:

```
def __init__(self):  
    self.movies = {}    # movie_id -> Movie object  
    self.adj_list = {}  # movie_id -> {neighbor_id: similarity_score}
```

Rich Relationships: Represents subtle movie similarities

Flexible Similarity: Various similarity measures (genre, actors, directors)

Scalable Recommendations: Efficient neighbor lookup

## **Benchmark Comparison**

Binary Search Tree

This data structure simply serves to store movies in a sorted hierarchical manner based on alphabetical title ordering that supports effective exact-match search. The BST organizes movies by forming a tree in which each node contains a film and the left subtree contains movies whose title is alphabetically prior to the node and the right subtree contains movies whose title is alphabetically subsequent. This allows the `retrieve()` method to search for a particular film by title in logarithmic time complexity when the conditions are balanced. The BST's primary function is to aid the precise title search feature in the user interface, wherein the users are able to retrieve a specific movie by typing its full title. The depth tracking feature in each node also provides details about the balance of the tree and can be used for optimization purposes.

## Graph Data Structure

MovieGraph data structure based on a weighted undirected graph where movies are represented by vertices and similarity relationships between movies are represented by edges. It is primarily utilized to store and quantify the similarity between movies using various measures of similarity like common directors, common actors, and common genres. Construction of the graph involves computing pairwise similarity scores by using the `combined_similarity()` function, which computes weighted Jaccard similarity across multiple movie features. Edges are drawn only between movie pairs with similarity values greater than a threshold (0.1 in the code). This creates a sparse graph with a focus on strong relationships. The graph is represented using the adjacency list, where each movie ID is stored as a mapping to a dictionary of neighboring movie IDs and their corresponding similarity scores. The data structure enables the recommendation system to query the most similar movies for any given movie very quickly by accessing its neighbors and sorting them in descending order of similarity score.

## Why Use Both BST and Graph?

### BST for Search Efficiency

- Fast exact title search
- Alphabetical ordering
- Memory-efficient storage

### Graph for Relationship Modeling

- Complex similarity relationships
- Multi-dimensional recommendations
- Dynamic relationship updates

## Future Improvements

### Advanced Similarity Measures

- User behavior analysis
- Temporal preferences
- Multi-modal content analysis

| Operation                                  | Average Case  | Worst Case    | Description                                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------|---------------|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Loading and Processing CSV Data            | $O(n)$        | $O(n)$        | Reading CSV and creating movie objects, where $n$ is the number of movies          |
| Building BST (CatalogueBST)                | $O(n \log n)$ | $O(n^2)$      | Each insertion averages $O(\log n)$ but degenerates to $O(n)$ if movies are sorted |
| Building Trie Structures                   | $O(n)$        | $O(n)$        | Inserting titles/genres takes $O(L)$ per movie, $L$ is constant relative to $n$    |
| Constructing Similarity Graph (MovieGraph) | $O(n^2)$      | $O(n^2)$      | similarity computation for every two movies                                        |
| Trie-based Prefix Search                   | $O(L + k)$    | $O(L + k)$    | $L$ for traversal, $k$ for collecting matching nodes                               |
| Recommendations                            | $O(d \log d)$ | $O(n \log n)$ | Sorting neighbors,                                                                 |

|           |  |  |                                                           |
|-----------|--|--|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Retrieval |  |  | d is similar movies<br>(can approach $n$ in dense graphs) |
|-----------|--|--|-----------------------------------------------------------|

| Function                      | Space Requirements | Description                                               |
|-------------------------------|--------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Movie Objects                 | $O(n)$             | Storing $n$ movie objects                                 |
| BST (CatalogueBST)            | $O(n)$             | Each movie stored in a BST node                           |
| Trie Structures               | $O(n)$             | $O(n \times L)$ worst case, but $L$ is constant           |
| Similarity Graph (MovieGraph) | $O(n^2)$           | Adjacency list representation in worst case (dense graph) |

## Time Complexity

### 1. Loading and Parsing CSV Data:

- Reading the CSV and creating movie objects runs in  $O(n)$  time where  $n$  is the number of movies. Each movie is processed once.

### 2. Building the BST (CatalogueBST):

- Insertion:
  - *Average Case:* If the BST stays relatively balanced, each insertion can take about  $O(\log n)$ , so overall  $O(n \log n)$  for  $n$  movies.
  - *Worst Case:* In the degenerate case (e.g., if the movies are sorted), each insertion can take  $O(n)$ , leading to  $O(n^2)$  worst-case performance.

### 3. Building the Trie Structures:

- Inserting each title (or genre key) into a Trie takes  $O(L)$  per movie, where  $L$  is the length of the title (or keyword).
- Since  $L$  is typically small and considered a constant with respect to  $n$ , the overall insertion across all movies is  $O(n)$ .

#### 4. Constructing the Similarity Graph (MovieGraph):

- The system computes pairwise similarity for every two movies using nested loops. This results in  $O(n^2)$  comparisons.
- The similarity computation itself involves set operations (intersections and unions) on small sets (genres, actors) which are effectively constant time per pair.
- Thus, the dominant time cost here is  $O(n^2)$ .

#### 5. Searching Operations:

- Trie-based Prefix Search: Finding a prefix is  $O(L)$  to traverse the Trie plus  $O(k)$  to collect the matching nodes, where  $k$  is the number of movies with that prefix.
- Recommendations Retrieval: Sorting the neighbors for a movie can take  $O(d \log d)$ , where  $d$  is the number of similar movies (neighbors). In the worst-case scenario, if nearly every movie is similar to every other (a dense graph),  $d$  can approach  $n$  (i.e.,  $O(n \log n)$ ). However, typical thresholds will limit  $d$  to a much smaller number.

Overall: The dominant factor in time complexity is the graph construction phase at  $O(n^2)$ , making the integrated system *quadratic* in the number of movies in the worst-case.

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#### Space Complexity

##### 1. Movie Objects:

- Storing  $n$  movie objects is  $O(n)$ .

## 2. BST (CatalogueBST):

- Each movie is stored in a BST node, giving  $O(n)$  space.

## 3. Trie Structures:

- The total space used by a Trie depends on the total number of characters stored. In the worst-case scenario (all titles having no overlapping prefixes), it would use  $O(n * L)$  space. With  $L$  as a constant, the overall space is  $O(n)$  but with a higher constant factor.

## 4. Similarity Graph (MovieGraph):

- In the worst-case scenario, every movie is similar to every other movie, and the adjacency list representation would require  $O(n^2)$  space.
- Since in practice the threshold for similarity limits the number of edges, the average case might be lower, but the worst-case remains  $O(n^2)$ .

Overall: Worst-case space complexity is  $O(n^2)$ , primarily due to the potential density of the similarity graph.

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## Summary

- Time Complexity: The integrated system has a worst-case time complexity of  $O(n^2)$  due to the pairwise similarity computations for the graph, with BST insertions averaging  $O(n \log n)$  (but potentially  $O(n^2)$  in worst-case scenarios).
- Space Complexity: In the worst-case, space usage is  $O(n^2)$  mainly from the similarity graph's adjacency list, while other data structures (BST and Trie) require  $O(n)$  additional space.

These complexities are acceptable for a dataset like "imdb\_top\_1000\_cleaned.csv" (with around 1,000 movies), but scaling to larger datasets might require optimizations, especially in the similarity graph construction.

Link to our app - <https://movieap.streamlit.app/>

Flowchart Link -

[https://drive.google.com/file/d/13yy0GfWaUSahR6g\\_PUjWond\\_3WAKiX6V/view?usp=sharing](https://drive.google.com/file/d/13yy0GfWaUSahR6g_PUjWond_3WAKiX6V/view?usp=sharing)

## References

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